```
        "type": "text"
      },
      "model":{
        "type": "text"
      },
      "registration_year":{
        "type": "date",
        "format": "dd-MM-yyyy"
      }
    }
  }
}
```

Now that we know how to set up an index with settings and mappings, the final piece in the jigsaw is to create an alias.

6.2.5 Index with aliases

Aliases are alternate names given to indexes for various purposes such as searching or aggregating data from multiple indexes (as a single alias) or enabling zero downtime during reindexing. Once we create an alias, we can use it for indexing, querying, and all other purposes as if it were an index. Aliases are handy during development as well as in production. We can also group multiple indexes and assign an alias to them so we can write queries against a single alias rather than a dozen indexes.

To create an index similar to the one we saw when configuring the index with settings and mappings (listing 6.11), we can set the alias information in an `aliases` object.

Listing 6.12 Creating an alias using an `aliases` object

```
PUT cars_for_aliases
{
  "aliases": {
    "my_new_cars_alias": {}
  }
}
```

Creates an index with an alias

Points the alias to the index

However, there's another way to create aliases, rather than using the index APIs: using an alias API. Elasticsearch exposes the alias API, and the syntax is as follows (check the `_alias` endpoint highlighted in bold):

```
PUT|POST <index_name>/_alias/<alias_name>
```

Let's create an alias called `my_cars_alias` that points to our `cars_for_aliases` index.

Listing 6.13 Creating an alias using an `_alias` endpoint

```
PUT cars_for_aliases/_alias/my_cars_alias
```